

# ReclaimKit - Complete User Guide

---

ReclaimKit contributors

## ReclaimKit — Complete User Guide

---

Everything you need to know and do to remove harmful Facebook content, delist from Google, and close your account.

| Field       | Details                                                                                                 |
|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| For         | Anyone removing harmful social content                                                                  |
| Toolkit     | <a href="#">ReclaimKit</a>                                                                              |
| Version     | August 2026                                                                                             |
| Legal basis | Configurable — set <code>jurisdiction</code> in <code>config.yaml</code> for your country's privacy law |

**Note:** For the latest test/deploy steps, see [README.md](#). This guide provides extended detail.

**Disclaimer:** ReclaimKit generates templates and tracks your campaign. It is **not legal advice** and is not affiliated with Meta, Google, or any paid removal service. Platform decisions are theirs; this guide helps you use official channels reputation firms use.

---

## Table of contents

1. [Will this work?](#)
2. [Your situation at a glance](#)
3. [What you need before you start](#)
4. [Facebook login — what matters](#)
5. [Install ReclaimKit](#)
6. [Configure your case](#)
7. [Day 1 — start the campaign](#)
8. [How to send Round 1 to Meta](#)
9. [Campaign tracks and timeline](#)
10. [Google delisting \(parallel track\)](#)
11. [Regulator complaint \(if Meta refuses\)](#)
12. [Closing Facebook after removal](#)
13. [Daily monitoring and VPS automation](#)
14. [All CLI commands reference](#)
15. [Windows 11 setup \(Docker + WSL\)](#)
16. [Costs and comparison to paid services](#)
17. [FAQ](#)
18. [Troubleshooting](#)
19. [Support contacts \(no police required\)](#)
20. [Checklist — print and tick off](#)
21. [Community Standards vs GDPR](#)

- 22. [Meta rejected your report — what now](#)
  - 23. [Docker — does it auto-save?](#)
  - 24. [Unsure who posted? \(safe wording\)](#)
  - 25. [Job hunting — will this hurt you?](#)
  - 26. [How long until content is erased?](#)
  - 27. [Cheap VPS for automation + free AI](#)
- 

## 1. Will this work?

---

**Yes — this is a proven, legitimate process.** Paid reputation firms (Removify, Erase.com, etc.) charge **£400-£2,000 per item** to submit the **same** GDPR emails, Meta escalation forms, and Google delisting requests that ReclaimKit generates for you.

### What ReclaimKit does

| Capability                   | Details                                                                                    |
|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 6-round Meta escalation      | Privacy initial, then reminder, Trust & Safety, rebuttal, regulator notice, post-regulator |
| 3-round Google delisting     | Defamation, then personal info, then resubmit with case history                            |
| 1 regulator complaint letter | Free authority pressure if Meta refuses after the response deadline                        |
| Evidence pack                | Hashed screenshots + case summary for attachments                                          |
| Search monitoring            | Scans public web for indexed mentions of your name                                         |
| Image search                 | Optional daily reverse-image scan (SerpAPI/TinEye)                                         |
| Slack alerts                 | Notifies you when new harmful URLs appear                                                  |
| VPS automation               | Daily monitor + optional auto-email to Meta (~£5/month)                                    |

### What no software can do

| Limitation               | Why                                                                         |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Instant deletion         | Only Meta can remove Facebook posts — there is no public delete API         |
| Auto-submit Google forms | Google has no API; you paste letter text into their web forms (~2 min each) |
| Scrape private groups    | Illegal / against ToS; ReclaimKit uses your saved URL and screenshots       |
| Guarantee removal        | Platforms decide; persistence and proper legal framing improve success      |
| Deanonymize commenters   | Meta will not reveal identities without legal disclosure                    |

**Realistic expectation:** Platforms must respond within the deadline set by your jurisdiction (often **30 days**). Many cases resolve in Round 1–3. If the platform refuses, regulator complaints are free and often effective. Google delisting hides content from search even if a copy exists elsewhere.

## 2. Example case (fill in your own details in config.yaml)

| Field                    | Example placeholder                                                     |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Your name                | Set in <code>config.yaml</code> → <code>subject.full_name</code>        |
| Location                 | Set in <code>config.yaml</code> → <code>subject.country</code>          |
| Harmful content          | Facebook group post with your photo + false allegations                 |
| Group                    | Set in <code>config.yaml</code> → <code>case.facebook.group_name</code> |
| Post URL                 | Set in <code>config.yaml</code> → <code>case.facebook.post_url</code>   |
| Already reported in-app? | Set <code>reported_to_meta: true</code> if applicable                   |

### Alleged commenters

Add handles to `config.yaml` → `case.alleged_commenters`. ReclaimKit **cannot** identify real people behind anonymous names — only the platform can, via legal process.

Example:

```
alleged_commenters:
- display_name: "ExampleUser1"
  comment: "Example harmful comment"
  posted_approx: "date unknown"
```

## 3. What you need before you start

**Required (you almost certainly have these)**

| Item                           | Used for                                                |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Your real email address</b> | Sending GDPR requests; Meta replies here                |
| <b>Postal address</b>          | Identity verification in letters (name + address)       |
| <b>Full legal name</b>         | As it appears on the harmful content                    |
| <b>Screenshots</b>             | Post, comments, your photo — saved locally              |
| <b>Post URL</b>                | Set in <code>config.yaml</code> after <code>init</code> |
| <b>A computer</b>              | Windows 11, Mac, or Linux                               |

### Helpful but optional

| Item                         | Used for                                                       |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Phone number</b>          | Included in letters; Meta may contact you                      |
| <b>Passport / ID</b>         | <b>Not sent upfront.</b> Meta may ask later to verify identity |
| <b>Slack webhook</b>         | Daily alerts when new URLs appear                              |
| <b>VPS (~£5/month)</b>       | Hands-off daily monitoring                                     |
| <b>SerpAPI or TinEye key</b> | Daily reverse-image search                                     |

### Not required

| Item                               | Notes                                             |
|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Facebook password long-term</b> | GDPR runs on email; see <a href="#">Section 4</a> |
| <b>Solicitor</b>                   | Only if platform + regulator both fail            |
| <b>Police report</b>               | Your chosen path avoids this                      |
| <b>Payment to Removify</b>         | Same process, self-service                        |

## 4. Facebook login — what matters

You are **currently logged into Facebook**. That is useful now. You plan to **close the account after removal** — that is the correct order.

### Works without Facebook login

- Email **privacy@facebook.com** with GDPR letters
- Meta escalation form: <https://www.facebook.com/help/contact/571927962827151>
- Regulator complaint (URL from `jurisdiction.regulator_url` in config)
- Google delisting forms
- All ReclaimKit commands ( `campaign` , `monitor` , `daemon` , etc.)

### Easier with Facebook login (do these now)

- Confirm the post is still live
- Take fresh screenshots if needed
- Download your Facebook data (Settings > Download your information)
- Save any in-app report reference numbers

### After you delete Facebook

- Meta can still process your GDPR request via **email**
- You **cannot** easily check if the post is gone — ask someone still in the group, or wait for Meta's reply
- **Deleting your account does NOT remove the post** — Meta must delete it separately

## Recommended order

1. Submit GDPR + escalation (while logged in)
2. Save screenshots and Meta reply emails locally
3. Wait up to 1 month for Meta
4. Confirm removal (check yourself or ask someone in the group)
5. Google delisting if anything still appears in search
6. THEN delete/deactivate Facebook
7. Keep monitoring 3–6 months via ReclaimKit (no Facebook needed)

## 5. Install ReclaimKit

### Option A — Local (quickest to start)

```
git clone https://github.com/tgollogly/reclaimkit.git
cd reclaimkit
pip install -r requirements.txt
python3 main.py init
```

This creates `config.yaml` from the template and `evidence/screenshots/` folder.

### Option B — VPS with Docker (set-and-forget monitoring)

See [Section 13](#) and `deploy/README.md`.

### Verify installation

```
python3 main.py doctor           # health check
python3 -m pytest tests/ -v      # run test suite (20 tests)
```

## 6. Configure your case

Edit `config.yaml` (never commit this file — it contains personal details).

If you created `config.yaml` before the latest update, copy new fields from `config.example.yaml` — especially `case.facebook.meta_reports` and `preferences`.

### Subject block — fill with your real details

```
subject:
  full_name: "Your Full Name"
  email: "your.email@example.com"
  phone: "+1 555 0100"
  address_line1: "Your street address"
  city: "Your city"
  region: ""           # state/province — optional
  postcode: "12345"
  country: "Your country"
```

### Case block — copy from config.example.yaml and edit

```

case:
  facebook:
    group_name: "Example Community Group"
    post_date: "2025-06-05"
    post_caption: "Example caption text"
    post_url: "https://www.facebook.com/groups/EXAMPLE/posts/EXAMPLE/"
    post_origin: uncertain # uncertain | third_party | self – see section 24
    reported_to_meta: true
    meta_reports:
      - type: "In-app content report (photo/post)"
        date: "2026-01-01"
        outcome: "Rejected – does not violate Community Standards"
        notes: "Attach Meta support screenshot"
      - type: "Group report"
        date: "2026-01-01"
        outcome: "Submitted"

```

Letters automatically cite these reports and explain why a Community Standards rejection does **not** answer a GDPR request.

## Optional harm statement

```

case:
  harm_statement: >
    Optional custom paragraph describing impact on you. If omitted, letters use
    a strong default harm/distress paragraph.

```

## Preferences

```

preferences:
  no_police: true
  closing_facebook_after_removal: true

```

## Evidence folders

```

evidence:
  screenshots_dir: "./evidence/screenshots"
  output_dir: "./output"

```

## Add screenshots

Copy your Facebook screenshots into `evidence/screenshots/` :

- Full post view (photo + caption visible)
- Each harmful comment (scroll and capture)
- Meta report confirmation screen
- **Meta “We didn’t remove the photo” support message (important for Round 1)**

Supported formats: PNG, JPG, JPEG, WEBP.

## Secrets (VPS only — use environment variables)

Copy `.env.example` to `.env` :

```

RECLAIMKIT SMTP_PASSWORD= # Gmail app password if auto-email enabled
RECLAIMKIT SLACK_WEBHOOK= # Slack incoming webhook URL
RECLAIMKIT SERPAPI_KEY= # Optional image search
RECLAIMKIT TINEYE_KEY= # Optional image search

```

**Never put passwords in `config.yaml` on a VPS. Use `.env` instead.**

## 7. Day 1 — start the campaign

---

Run these commands in order:

```
# 1. Build evidence pack (hashed screenshots + summary)
python3 main.py evidence

# 2. Start campaign and generate Round 1 letters
python3 main.py campaign init

# 3. Check everything looks correct
python3 main.py doctor
python3 main.py campaign status
```

Or run everything in one go:

```
python3 main.py all
```

### What gets created

```
output/
  campaign/
    state.json                      (tracks your progress)
  campaign-package-YYYYMMDD.../
    README.txt
    round-01-meta/
      meta_r1_gdpr_initial.txt      (EMAIL THIS TO META)
      SUBMIT.txt                   (step-by-step instructions)
    round-01-google/
      google_r1_defamation.txt
      SUBMIT.txt
  evidence-pack-YYYYMMDD.../        (attach to emails if needed)
```

Each letter includes a **case reference** like `RK-ER-YOURNAME-META-R1` (generated from your name in config). Always put this in the email subject line.

---

## 8. How to send Round 1 to Meta

---

This is the **most important step**. It starts the legal response clock for your jurisdiction.

### Step-by-step

1. Open `output/campaign-package-.../round-01-meta/meta_r1_gdpr_initial.txt`
2. Open your email client (Gmail, Outlook, etc.)
3. **To:** `privacy@facebook.com`
4. **CC (optional):** `dpo@facebook.com`
5. **Subject:** `RK-ER-YOURNAME-META-R1 – Article 17 Erasure Request – Your Full Name`
6. **Body:** Paste the entire letter
7. **Attachments:** All screenshots from `evidence/screenshots/`
8. Send from the **same email address** listed in `config.yaml`
9. Record submission in ReclaimKit:

```
python3 main.py campaign sent --track meta --round 1
```

### Tips for a strong submission

- Send from your real email — Meta may reply asking for verification
- Attach clear screenshots showing your face, name, and harmful comments
- Keep a copy of the sent email in a folder (or export to PDF)

- Do **not** send your passport unless Meta explicitly asks in a reply

## If you already reported in-app

Round 1 mentions your prior report. Meta sometimes treats GDPR as a separate, stronger legal obligation — send it anyway.

## 9. Campaign tracks and timeline

ReclaimKit runs three parallel **tracks**. Meta is the priority.

### Meta track — 6 rounds

| Round     | Letter                                 | When to send                                     |
|-----------|----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| <b>R1</b> | GDPR Article 17 initial request        | <b>Day 1 — send today</b>                        |
| <b>R2</b> | GDPR reminder (no response)            | 7+ days after R1 with no removal                 |
| <b>R3</b> | Trust & Safety escalation              | 7+ days after R2, or if refused                  |
| <b>R4</b> | Formal rebuttal to refusal             | When Meta refuses with a reason                  |
| <b>R5</b> | Notice of intended regulator complaint | After <code>response_days</code> with no removal |
| <b>R6</b> | Post-regulator follow-up to Meta       | After regulator accepts complaint                |

### Generate next round automatically:

```
# No response after 7 days
python3 main.py campaign no-response --track meta

# Meta refused — include their reason
python3 main.py campaign refused --track meta --reason "They said it doesn't violate community standards"

# Manually generate a specific round
python3 main.py campaign next --track meta --round 3
```

### Round 3+ also submit the escalation form:

<https://www.facebook.com/help/contact/571927962827151>

(No Facebook login required for this form.)

## Recording submissions

Every time you send a letter or submit a form:

```
python3 main.py campaign sent --track meta --round 2
python3 main.py campaign sent --track google --round 1
python3 main.py campaign sent --track regulator --round 1 --reference REG-REF-12345
```

## Check progress anytime

```
python3 main.py campaign status
```

## Mark success



When the post and comments are gone:

```
python3 main.py campaign success --note "Post removed confirmed 2026-08-XX"
python3 main.py close # prints Facebook closure checklist
```

## 10. Google delisting (parallel track)

Google removal **hides content from search** — it does not delete the Facebook post. Run this **in parallel** with Meta, especially if your name or photo appears in Google results.

### Round 1 — Defamation

1. Open `output/campaign-package-.../round-01-google/google_r1_defamation.txt`
2. Follow the URL in the letter header (Google Legal Troubleshooter)
3. Paste relevant sections into the form
4. Record: `python3 main.py campaign sent --track google --round 1`

### Additional Google tools

| Tool                             | URL                                                                                                                                               | Use when                             |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| <b>Defamation troubleshooter</b> | <a href="https://support.google.com/legal/troubleshooter/1114905">https://support.google.com/legal/troubleshooter/1114905</a>                     | False allegations in search snippets |
| <b>Personal info removal</b>     | <a href="https://support.google.com/websearch/contact/content_removal_form">https://support.google.com/websearch/contact/content_removal_form</a> | Photo, address, phone in results     |
| <b>Results About You</b>         | <a href="https://myactivity.google.com/results-about-you">https://myactivity.google.com/results-about-you</a>                                     | Ongoing alerts for new mentions      |

### Monitor for new URLs

```
python3 main.py monitor
```

Reports save to `output/search-monitor-*.txt` and `.json`. Submit delisting for any harmful URLs found.

**Google forms are manual (~2 minutes each)** — ReclaimKit drafts the text; you paste it in.

## 11. Regulator complaint (if Meta refuses)

If Meta does not remove content within the deadline set in `jurisdiction.response_days`, or explicitly refuses your erasure request, escalate to your **data protection authority** — free, no police, no court.

### When to file

- Response deadline passed since Round 1 with no removal
- Meta sent a refusal citing “community standards” or similar
- After Meta Round 4 (rebuttal) failed

### How to file

1. Generate regulator letter: `python3 main.py campaign next --track regulator`
2. Go to the URL in `jurisdiction.regulator_url` in your config
3. Attach:
  - Evidence pack from `output/evidence-pack-.../`

- All Meta correspondence (your emails + their replies)
- Screenshots

4. Record: `python3 main.py campaign sent --track regulator --round 1 --reference YOUR-REG-REF`

## After the regulator

- The authority may contact Meta on your behalf
- Send Meta Round 5 (regulator notice) when you file
- Send Meta Round 6 after the regulator acknowledges the complaint

## 12. Closing Facebook after removal

**Do NOT delete Facebook until removal is confirmed or you have exhausted the privacy/regulator path.**

Run the built-in checklist:

```
python3 main.py close
```

### Before deleting your account

- ☐ Download your data: Settings > Download your information
- ☐ Save all Meta reply emails locally
- ☐ Save evidence pack and campaign letters from `output/`
- ☐ Remove apps connected to Facebook (Settings > Apps and websites)
- ☐ Update logins on sites where you used “Log in with Facebook”
- ☐ Confirm post is gone (check while still logged in, or ask someone in the group)

### Deactivate vs delete

| Action                    | Effect                                          |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Deactivate</b>         | Profile hidden; reversible for 30 days          |
| <b>Delete permanently</b> | Cannot log back in; data scheduled for deletion |

Path: Settings and privacy > Settings > Accounts Centre > Personal details > Account ownership and control > Deactivation or deletion

### After Facebook is closed

- Continue `python3 main.py monitor` monthly for 3-6 months
- Re-submit Google delisting if new URLs appear
- Meta GDPR follow-up still works via email to `privacy@facebook.com`

## 13. Daily monitoring and VPS automation

Optional but recommended if you want hands-off daily checks (~£5/month VPS).

### What runs automatically (Docker or cron)

| Task                                                | Frequency                           |
|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Web search for your name                            | Daily                               |
| Reverse image search (if API key set)               | Daily                               |
| Slack alert on new harmful URLs                     | When found                          |
| Auto-generate next Meta letter after 7 days silence | If enabled                          |
| Auto-email Meta                                     | Optional ( auto_send_emails: true ) |

## Docker quick start

```
cd deploy
docker compose up -d --build
```

Logs: `output/cron.log` and `output/automation-log.jsonl`

## Cron (no Docker)

```
0 8 * * * cd /path/to/reclaimkit && python3 main.py daemon once >> output/cron.log 2>&1
```

## Test automation without sending

```
python3 main.py daemon once --dry-run
```

## Slack setup

1. Create incoming webhook: `https://api.slack.com/messaging/webhooks`
2. Add URL to `config.yaml` under `automation.slack_webhook_url`
3. Or set `RECLAIMKIT_SLACK_WEBHOOK` in `.env`

Full VPS details: `deploy/README.md`

---

## 14. All CLI commands reference

---

| Command                                                                   | Purpose                                              |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>python3 main.py init</code>                                         | Create <code>config.yaml</code> and evidence folders |
| <code>python3 main.py evidence</code>                                     | Build hashed evidence pack                           |
| <code>python3 main.py letters</code>                                      | Generate standalone takedown letters (non-campaign)  |
| <code>python3 main.py campaign init</code>                                | Start campaign + Round 1 package                     |
| <code>python3 main.py campaign status</code>                              | Show progress dashboard                              |
| <code>python3 main.py campaign sent --track meta --round N</code>         | Record submission                                    |
| <code>python3 main.py campaign no-response --track meta</code>            | 7-day silence, then next round                       |
| <code>python3 main.py campaign refused --track meta --reason "..."</code> | Refusal, then rebuttal letter                        |
| <code>python3 main.py campaign next --track meta --round N</code>         | Generate specific round                              |
| <code>python3 main.py campaign success</code>                             | Mark content removed                                 |
| <code>python3 main.py monitor</code>                                      | Scan search for indexed URLs                         |
| <code>python3 main.py osint</code>                                        | Document commenter handles                           |
| <code>python3 main.py guide</code>                                        | Print removal action guide                           |
| <code>python3 main.py close</code>                                        | Facebook closure checklist                           |
| <code>python3 main.py doctor</code>                                       | Validate config, deps, letters                       |
| <code>python3 main.py daemon once</code>                                  | Run daily automation cycle                           |
| <code>python3 main.py daemon once --dry-run</code>                        | Test without writes/emails                           |
| <code>python3 main.py all</code>                                          | Evidence + campaign + osint + monitor                |

Global option: `--config path/to/config.yaml` (default: `config.yaml`)

## 15. Windows 11 setup (Docker + WSL)

ReclaimKit is Python and runs best on **WSL2** (Windows Subsystem for Linux). Docker Desktop integrates with WSL.

### Step 1 — Install WSL2

Open PowerShell as Administrator:

```
wsl --install
```

Restart if prompted. Ubuntu is the default distribution.

### Step 2 — Install Docker Desktop

1. Download from <https://www.docker.com/products/docker-desktop/>
2. Install and enable **WSL 2 backend** in Settings > General
3. Enable integration with your Ubuntu distro in Settings > Resources > WSL Integration

### Step 3 — Clone and run in WSL

Open Ubuntu (WSL terminal):

```
sudo apt update && sudo apt install -y python3 python3-pip git
git clone https://github.com/tgollogly/reclaimkit.git
cd reclaimkit
pip install -r requirements.txt
python3 main.py init
# Edit config.yaml with: nano config.yaml
# Add screenshots to evidence/screenshots/
python3 main.py campaign init
python3 main.py doctor
```

### Step 4 — Optional VPS-style Docker monitoring

From WSL, inside the repo:

```
cd deploy
docker compose up -d --build
docker compose logs -f
```

### Accessing files from Windows

WSL files live at `\\wsl$\\Ubuntu\\home\\<username>\\reclaimkit\\` in File Explorer. You can copy screenshots there directly.

### Testing on Windows (no VPS)

You do **not** need Docker for the core workflow. Local Python in WSL is enough:

```
python3 main.py campaign init
# Email Meta manually using the generated letter
python3 main.py campaign sent --track meta --round 1
python3 main.py monitor
```

---

## 16. Costs and comparison to paid services

| Option                 | Cost                            | Notes                                  |
|------------------------|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| ReclaimKit (local)     | £0                              | Your time only                         |
| VPS monitoring         | ~£5/month                       | Hetzner, DigitalOcean, etc.            |
| SerpAPI (image search) | ~\$50/month free tier available | Optional                               |
| Removify               | £400-£2,000 per item            | Same forms and emails                  |
| Solicitor              | Varies                          | Only if platform + regulator both fail |

ReclaimKit automates what paid services do manually: letter drafting, escalation timing, monitoring, and record-keeping.

---

## 17. FAQ

### Do I need my Facebook password?

**Not for the removal process.** GDPR runs on your email and postal address. Login helps you check the post and

take screenshots now, but follow-up works without it.

### Do I need to send my passport?

**Not in Round 1.** Meta may ask for ID in a reply email to verify you are the data subject. Only send if they request it.

### I already reported the post in-app. Do I still send GDPR?

**Yes.** In-app reports and GDPR Article 17 requests are different channels. GDPR creates a legal deadline Meta must meet.

### Will deleting Facebook remove the post?

**No.** The post must be removed by Meta while your request is active. Close your account **after** removal.

### Can this hurt my US travel or create a public record?

This process is **private correspondence** with Meta/Google/your regulator — not a public court case or police record. Google delisting **reduces** public visibility. Avoid posting about the case on public blogs (higher SEO risk than a private group).

### Can ReclaimKit identify who posted the comments?

**No.** Anonymous Facebook handles cannot be deanonymized without Meta legal disclosure. Focus on **content removal**, not confronting individuals.

### What if Meta says “doesn’t violate community standards”?

Record the refusal and generate Round 4 (rebuttal):

```
python3 main.py campaign refused --track meta --reason "Pasted Meta's exact reply here"
```

Then proceed toward a regulator complaint if still not removed after the response deadline.

### How long does it take?

| Stage                 | Typical timeframe                                             |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Meta privacy response | Up to <code>jurisdiction.response_days</code> (often 30 days) |
| Google delisting      | Days to weeks                                                 |
| Regulator complaint   | Weeks to months                                               |
| Full campaign         | 1-3 months in most cases                                      |

## 18. Troubleshooting

### Run the doctor (health check — not Docker)

**Doctor** = validate your setup before sending letters. **Docker** = run daily monitoring on a VPS (section 23).

```
python3 main.py doctor
python3 main.py --config config.example.yaml doctor # validate template
```

Core checks must pass (marked ✓). Warnings (marked !) are items you must fix before emailing Meta — placeholder email, missing screenshots, etc.

### Common issues

| Problem                            | Fix                                                                                  |
|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>config.yaml</code> not found | Run <code>python3 main.py init</code>                                                |
| No campaign found                  | Run <code>python3 main.py campaign init</code>                                       |
| No screenshots found               | Add PNG/JPG files to <code>evidence/screenshots/</code>                              |
| Monitor import error               | <code>pip install duckduckgo-search</code>                                           |
| SMTP auto-email fails              | Use Gmail App Password, not main password; set <code>RECLAIMKIT_SMTP_PASSWORD</code> |
| Letters missing your name          | Edit <code>config.yaml</code> subject block                                          |

## Run tests

```
python3 -m pytest tests/ -v
```

All 20 tests should pass.

Run the full audit script:

```
chmod +x scripts/audit.sh
./scripts/audit.sh
```

## 19. Support contacts

| Service                               | Contact                                                              | Use for                   |
|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| <b>Your data protection authority</b> | URL in <code>jurisdiction.regulator_url</code>                       | Platform privacy failures |
| <b>Meta DPO</b>                       | <code>privacy@facebook.com</code> ,<br><code>dpo@facebook.com</code> | Data erasure requests     |

Set `jurisdiction.regulator_name` and `jurisdiction.regulator_url` in config for your country. Solicitors remain optional if the platform and regulator both fail.

## 20. Checklist — print and tick off

### Phase 1 — Setup (Day 1)

- ☐ Clone repo and run `pip install -r requirements.txt`
- ☐ Run `python3 main.py init`
- ☐ Fill real email, address, phone in `config.yaml`
- ☐ Copy screenshots to `evidence/screenshots/`
- ☐ Run `python3 main.py evidence`
- ☐ Run `python3 main.py campaign init`
- ☐ Run `python3 main.py doctor` (all checks green)

### Phase 2 — Meta removal (Week 1)

- ☐ Email Round 1 letter to `privacy@facebook.com`
- ☐ Subject line includes your case reference from the generated letter (e.g. `RK-ER-YOURNAME-META-R1` )
- ☐ Attach all screenshots

- ☐ Run `python3 main.py campaign sent --track meta --round 1`
- ☐ Save sent email and any Meta reply

### Phase 3 — Google (parallel)

- ☐ Run `python3 main.py monitor`
- ☐ Submit Google Round 1 if URLs found
- ☐ Enable Results About You on Google account
- ☐ Run `python3 main.py campaign sent --track google --round 1`

### Phase 4 — Follow-up (Weeks 2-4)

- ☐ If no removal in 7 days: `campaign no-response --track meta`
- ☐ If Meta refuses: `campaign refused --track meta --reason "..."`
- ☐ Round 3+: submit escalation form at [facebook.com/help/contact/571927962827151](https://facebook.com/help/contact/571927962827151)
- ☐ If response deadline passes: regulator complaint + Meta Round 5

### Phase 5 — After removal

- ☐ Confirm post gone (while logged in or via someone in group)
- ☐ Run `python3 main.py campaign success`
- ☐ Download Facebook data
- ☐ Run `python3 main.py close` and follow checklist
- ☐ Delete/deactivate Facebook account
- ☐ Monitor monthly 3-6 months: `python3 main.py monitor`

## 21. Community Standards vs GDPR

These are **two different doors** into Meta. ReclaimKit is built for the legal one.

|                      | Community Standards (Report button) | Privacy erasure request ( <a href="mailto:privacy@facebook.com">privacy@facebook.com</a> ) |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Question</b>      | Does this break Meta's house rules? | Must you delete my personal data?                                                          |
| <b>Team</b>          | Content moderation                  | Data protection / privacy                                                                  |
| <b>Deadline</b>      | None                                | Set by your jurisdiction (often <b>30 days</b> )                                           |
| <b>Your outcome</b>  | Rejected ("no violation")           | Still pending until DPO responds                                                           |
| <b>Bullying/harm</b> | Often dismissed as "discussion"     | Harm supports erasure + distress                                                           |

**Bullying is harmful.** Meta's rejection only means their moderation system did not classify it as a policy breach. Applicable privacy law still covers your photo, name, and comments about you.

## 22. Meta rejected your report — what now

If you received: *"We didn't remove the photo" / "doesn't go against Community Standards"*:

1. **Save a screenshot** to `evidence/screenshots/`
2. Add under `case.facebook.meta_reports` in `config.yaml` (see `config.example.yaml`)
3. **Send GDPR Round 1 anyway** — the letter now cites the rejection explicitly
4. Record refusal:



```
python3 main.py campaign refused --track meta --reason "In-app report rejected: does not violate Community Standards (12 Aug 2026)"
```

5. Attach the rejection screenshot to every Meta email

Paid removal firms see this rejection daily. Their next step is always **GDPR to privacy@facebook.com** — same as you.

## 23. Docker — does it auto-save?

**Not the same as doctor :** **Docker** runs ReclaimKit on a VPS in the background. `python3 main.py doctor` is a separate health-check command (config, screenshots, letters). See [section 18](#) for `doctor`.

**Yes.** Docker does not lose your campaign when the container restarts.

These folders are **mounted from your PC/VPS** (not stored only inside the container):

| Host path                   | What is saved                                             |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| output/                     | Campaign state, letters, monitor reports, automation logs |
| output/campaign/state.json  | Round tracking ( campaign sent , etc.)                    |
| output/automation-log.jsonl | Daily daemon history                                      |
| evidence/                   | Screenshots and evidence packs                            |

From `deploy/docker-compose.yml` :

```
volumes:
  - ../config.yaml:/app/config.yaml:ro
  - ../evidence:/app/evidence
  - ../output:/app/output
```

**What persists automatically when daemon once runs:**

- Updated `state.json` after escalation
- New monitor JSON reports
- `seen_urls.json` (URLs already alerted)
- Appended lines in `automation-log.jsonl`

**What is NOT automatic:**

- Sending Round 1 initially (you run `campaign init` once)
- Recording `campaign sent` unless you run the command (or auto-email sends)
- Google form submission (always manual)

**Safe workflow:**

```
python3 main.py campaign init
python3 main.py campaign sent --track meta --round 1
cd deploy && docker compose up -d --build
```

If the container is deleted and recreated, **your data remains** in `output/` and `evidence/` on the host.

## 24. Unsure who posted? (safe wording)

**You can still remove everything.** Applicable privacy law protects **your data** — not only cases where someone

else posted.

If you do not remember whether you posted the caption yourself (e.g. after drinking, testing the group), use:

```
case:
  facebook:
    post_origin: uncertain # DEFAULT – safest
```

| Value              | When to use                                                             |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>uncertain</b>   | You are not sure who created the post — <b>use this if in any doubt</b> |
| <b>third_party</b> | You are certain someone else posted your photo/name                     |
| <b>self</b>        | You posted it and want all data + comments removed                      |

**uncertain** letters say: - You request erasure of your photo, name, and comments - You do **not** consent to continued processing - **Without claiming** someone else definitely posted - **Without admitting** you posted — legally neutral

You are **not** required to tell Meta you might have posted drunk. Do **not** lie if they ask directly later.

The harmful **comments** are still from other people — erasing those protects you regardless of who wrote the caption.

---

## 25. Job hunting — will this hurt you?

| Risk                                      | Level       | Notes                                                                                  |
|-------------------------------------------|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Private group post</b>                 | Medium      | Not on Google for everyone, but group members see it                                   |
| <b>Google search for your name</b>        | Medium-High | If indexed, employers <i>may</i> find it —<br>run <code>python3 main.py monitor</code> |
| <b>Niche community groups</b>             | Low         | Most recruiters do not search specific groups by name                                  |
| <b>After Meta removal + Google delist</b> | Low         | Source gone + search hidden = much safer                                               |

**What helps job hunting:** 1. Remove source (Meta privacy request) — **do this first** 2. Google delisting + **Results About You** alerts 3. Do **not** post about the case publicly (creates new SEO) 4. LinkedIn/CV focus on skills — most employers check LinkedIn, not niche groups

**Reality:** Until removed, there is **some** risk if someone Googles you. After removal and delisting (typically 1–3 months), risk drops sharply. This is **not** a criminal record or court case — it does not appear on standard employment checks.

---

## 26. How long until content is erased?

| Stage                  | Typical time            | What happens                                                            |
|------------------------|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Send privacy Round 1   | Day 1 (today)           | Clock starts — platform has until <code>response_days</code> to respond |
| Meta removes post      | 1-4 weeks               | Many cases resolve Round 1-3                                            |
| Meta refuses / silence | Week 2-4                | Escalation rounds + regulator                                           |
| Regulator complaint    | Week 4-8+               | Free authority pressure                                                 |
| Google delisting       | 1-4 weeks after submit  | Hides from search (parallel track)                                      |
| Google cache clears    | Days-weeks after delist | Old snippets may linger briefly                                         |
| Full campaign          | 1-3 months typical      | Complex refusals take longer                                            |

Private group posts are often **not indexed** by Google — but run monitor to check.

There is **no instant delete** — Meta has up to one month by law. ReclaimKit automates follow-up so you do not pay £400+ for someone else to send the same emails.

## 27. Cheap VPS for automation + free AI

Full guide: [deploy/VPS-GUIDE.md](#)

| Provider          | Cost      | Recommendation                                                     |
|-------------------|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Hetzner CX22      | ~£4.50/mo | <b>Best value</b> — 4 GB RAM, EU servers, runs Docker + ReclaimKit |
| DigitalOcean      | ~\$6/mo   | Easy for beginners                                                 |
| Oracle Cloud Free | £0        | Powerful if you get approved — setup harder                        |

One VPS can run: - ReclaimKit daily monitor (this repo) - **Ollama** — free local AI (Llama, Mistral) - n8n, Uptime Kuma, VPN, other scripts

```
cd deploy && docker compose up -d --build
```

Data **auto-saves** to `output/` on the host — see section 23.

**ReclaimKit** | MIT License | Copyright 2026 ReclaimKit contributors

Not legal advice. Not affiliated with Meta or Google.